JAMES MATTHEW HARRISON

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Backend engineer with 12 years building scalable systems for fintech and e-commerce platforms. I've led migration projects from monolithic architectures to microservices, mentored junior developers, and established coding standards that stuck. I'm most interested in problems involving data consistency, API design, and system resilience under high load.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Senior Backend Engineer

Quantum Payments Ltd

quantum-payments.io

Birmingham, United Kingdom

March 2021 - Present

Architected payment processing pipeline handling 50 million transactions daily across multiple currencies with 99.99% uptime.

Led migration of legacy payment system to event-driven microservices using Kafka, reducing transaction latency by 65%.

Mentored team of 6 backend engineers, conducted code reviews, and established Go coding standards adopted across 40+ services.

Designed and implemented distributed cache strategy using Redis that improved API response times from 850ms to 120ms for customer dashboard queries.

Staff Backend Engineer

FinServe Solutions

finserve-solutions.co

Birmingham, United Kingdom

June 2017 - February 2021

Managed database optimization initiative that improved query performance by 40% and reduced infrastructure costs by 28% annually.

Built authentication and authorization microservice in Java handling 10 million API requests daily for 200+ third-party integrations.

Established incident response procedures and post-mortem culture that reduced mean time to recovery from 4 hours to 45 minutes.

Implemented comprehensive API monitoring and alerting system that caught 95% of issues before customer impact.

Backend Developer

DataFlow Analytics

dataflow-analytics.net

Birmingham, United Kingdom

January 2012 - May 2017

Developed REST APIs in Python for data pipeline processing, handling ingestion of 2TB daily data across logistics clients.

Optimized PostgreSQL queries and introduced database connection pooling that reduced server load by 50%.

Implemented background job queue system using Celery that processed 500,000 jobs daily without queue backlog.

Collaborated with data science team to create batch processing jobs for machine learning model feature preparation.

EDUCATION

University of Birmingham

BSc Computer Science

Graduated June 2011

SKILLS

Backend Development: Java, Python, Go, SQL

Databases: PostgreSQL, MySQL, MongoDB, Redis

Messaging & Queues: Kafka, RabbitMQ, AWS SQS

Cloud Platforms: AWS, Google Cloud Platform

Container & Orchestration: Docker, Kubernetes

System Design: Microservices, Event-Driven Architecture

API Design: REST, gRPC

DevOps & Tools: Git, Jenkins, GitHub Actions, Terraform